



Common houseleek, Northern Africa, Europe, and western Asia



Tenerife houseleek, Europe



Mountain houseleek, Europe

These are not the leeks we eat, but you do find them in houses. You might have seen houseleeks in pots on windowsills, or in warm gardens. However, their natural habitat is rocky mountains. People love houseleeks because they are incredibly tough and easy to grow. They are a type of plant called a succulent (suck-u-lent), which have fat and squidgy leaves. They use their leaves to store water in their dry, stony home, so you barely need to water them!

Sometimes houseleeks are known as "hen and chicks" because of how they spread. The houseleek multiplies by making tiny copies of itself on long stems. The parent plant in the middle is the "hen" and its babies are the "chicks".

